

Last Will and Testament

Let this stand as the last will and testament of Adam Takvam (aka Severin Aequus) as of 2027¹¹⁹. This shall be taken as legally binding at the time of death unless a later version exists that supersedes it.

EXECUTOR

If I have a wife, then she is the executor. If I don't and someone else wants to assume the role, then they are the executor. If no one wants the role, then I suppose it falls to the state.

MATERIAL POSSESSIONS

Material possessions are defined herein as any physical items, including personal items, electronics, collectables, books, art, etc. It also includes all manner of economic instruments including cash, bank accounts, investment accounts, interest, dividends, and ongoing royalty payments.

Since I live modestly, I suspect I will have nothing of significant value to leave in terms of any inheritance. If, by some chance, I do, then it should go to my wife should one exist. For my purposes, a domestic partner is a wife regardless of whether paperwork has been filed to that effect or not. If no wife exists, then donate whatever I leave behind a charity that is directly working to house the homeless.

¹¹⁹ No, I didn't consult a lawyer. This is clear enough for you to figure it out.

REMAINS

I will offer you the choice of two possible means of disposing of my remains:

Cremation

If you choose this option, then you must comply with my wished regarding the treatment of the ashes:

First, the executor of my estate must create - or contract a sculpture artist to create – a suitable frame. It must be made of teak, mahogany, or a comparable dark hardwood that must be properly sealed and finished.

The design is as follows:

- A flat square top and bottom - The edges must be decoratively finished.
- Four pillars – one attached to each corner. The pillars must be formed on a lathe and contain tasteful decorative embellishment. They must be at least 10” in height but may be larger if desired.
- Stand – Small nubs should appear as though the pillars are protruding through the top and bottom. Whether they literally do or not is up to your discretion.

Now that you’re sufficiently confused, you will have to retain the services of an accomplished glassblower for the second part.

The center of the frame must feature an hourglass.

- It should be open on the top and bottom where it will join with the frame to contain the ashes.

- The height must naturally agree with the height of the pillars, so there will need to be a meeting to agree on the exact specifications.
- My ashes will obviously serve as the sand.
- Ensure that the precise amount of ashes are added so that the hourglass runs for precisely one hour!

In the ideal embodiment of this directive, you would just hand all of these instructions to a recognized artisan such as Salt, Laceface, Darby, Lyons, etc and just let them handle the whole thing and pay them whatever they ask. Indeed, if sufficient funds exist in the estate to cover this cost, then that is the required approach. If the executor is able to cover the difference, then you should still go with this approach. Let the artist handle it and adorn the finished product according to their taste and style.

If you feel hopelessly lost about how to do this, contact a manager at Connoisseur Smoke Shop - or a similar ultra-premium functional glass boutique - and send them this requirement. They will make it happen. Note, however, that the end product is an hourglass, not a pipe!

If funds do not exist for this approach, then do it the Home Depot way and do your very best to make it look nice.

If I die absolutely penniless and my executor is similarly indigent, then only as a last resort, purchase a premade hourglass, dump the sand, and replace it with my ashes. But do so only as a temporary measure until it is possible to upgrade me to a vessel compliant with my wishes as outlined above.

Once created, the hourglass binds my egregore. As such, it should always be regarded with reverence:

- It should be placed in a conspicuous location in the executor's home – or the home of a person they specifically designate.
- It may be used functionally to tell time, if desired.
- It must always be carefully protected from being damaged¹²⁰.
- Never place anything on top of it.
- Do not cover it except as required to protect it during transport.
- Never put it in a storage unit!
- It may be handed down or passed to a new caretaker, but it may never be sold.

If the hourglass is damaged, it must be sent to the artist who created it, if possible, immediately for repair. If the original artist is unavailable, a comparably talented artisan must be contracted to perform the repair. If any ash is lost, then replace it with any retained excess. If no excess has been retained, then use fucking sand, but be much more careful in the future!

Any excess ashes should be retained in case an accident causes some ash to be lost. This excess can be stored however you like so long as it is not unrecoverable.

For example:

Keep it in a locket. [Good]

Toss it into wet concrete. [Bad]

Burial

If you choose this option, then a headstone is mandatory. Additionally, said headstone must prominently feature the words “YOU ARE ALL MORONS!” with my pen name, Severin Aequus, underneath followed by my birth and death dates.

¹²⁰ I absolutely will be watching!

Directly in front of my tombstone, a flower vase must be kept perpetually stocked with fresh Rothschild's slipper orchid (*Paphiopedilum rothschildianum*), also called the Gold of Kinabalu. You can acquire one by visiting Mount Kinabalu in Borneo. Once an example has been obtained, I highly recommend that you construct a greenhouse and use that example to grow the replacements indefinitely.

So there you have it, two *equally viable* options. The choice is entirely yours!